

# Tyler Han

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## EDUCATION

### • University of Washington

Ph.D. Computer Science

June 2022 - Present

Advisor: [Byron Boots](#)

### • University of Maryland

B.S. Aerospace Engineering | B.S. Computer Science | Minor: Mathematics

Sep 2018 - May 2022

GPA: 3.9 / 4.0

## RESEARCH INTEREST

I am interested in methods which enable robots to attain the same level of efficiency and robustness as animals. With experience in field engineering and robotics, I am heavily influenced by real-world deployment.

## PUBLICATIONS

1. [Tyler Han](#), Bat Nemekhbald, Siyang Shen, Rohan Baijal, Richard Ebock, Harine Ravichandiran, Sanghun Jung, Kevin Huang, Byron Boots. "Online World Modeling Enables Real-World Inverse Reinforcement Learning from Observation", *Conference on Robot Learning (CoRL)*, 2026. [\[pdf\]](#) [\[website\]](#)
2. [Tyler Han](#), Yanda Bao, Bhaumik Mehta, Gabriel Guo, Anubhav Vishwakarma, Emily Kang, Sanghun Jung, Rosario Scalise, Bryan Xu, Byron Boots. "Model Predictive Adversarial Imitation Learning for Planning from Observation", *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2026. [\[pdf\]](#)
3. [Tyler Han](#), Preet Shah, Sidharth Rajagopal, Yanda Bao, Sanghun Jung, Sidharth Talia, Gabriel Guo, Bryan Xu, Bhaumik Mehta, Emma Romig, Rosario Scalise, Byron Boots. "Wheeled Lab: Modern Sim2Real for Low-Cost, Open-source Wheeled Robotics", *Conference on Robot Learning (CoRL)*, 2025. [\[pdf\]](#) [\[website\]](#)
4. [Tyler Han](#), Alex Liu, Alex Spitzer, Guanya Shi, Byron Boots. "Model Predictive Control for Aggressive Driving Over Uneven Terrain", *Robotics: Science and Systems (RSS)*, 2024. [\[pdf\]](#) [\[website\]](#)
5. Chuning Zhu, Xinqi Wang, [Tyler Han](#), Simon Du, Abhishek Gupta. "Distributional Successor Features Enable Zero-Shot Policy Optimization", *Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, 2024. [\[pdf\]](#) [\[website\]](#)

## PREPRINTS

1. Anubhav Vishwakarma, Caleb Hsu, Byron Boots, <sup>†</sup>[Tyler Han](#), <sup>†</sup>Karen Leung. "Discriminative Barrier Functions for Safe Adversarial Imitation Learning from Observation", *In Submission*, 2026. [\[pdf\]](#)
2. [Tyler Han](#), Sidharth Talia, Rohan Panicker, Preet Shah, Neel Jawale, Byron Boots. "Dynamics Models in the Aggressive Off-Road Driving Regime", *International Conference on Robotics and Automation (ICRA). Workshop on Off-Road Autonomy*, 2024. [\[pdf\]](#)

## PROJECTS

### • Wheeled Lab

University of Washington

February 2025 - Present



- Full low-cost Sim2Real ecosystem and now student org. (WL@UW [\[website\]](#)) for students new to RL in robotics.

### • Robotic Autonomy in Complex Environments with Resiliency (RACER)

Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency (DARPA)

June 2022 - May 2024



- Planning & control for autonomous high-speed field UGV of top performing team, now Overland AI

### • Autonomous Tunnel Boring

The Boring Company | Not-a-Boring Competition

Sep 2020 - May 2022

- Navigation; one of twelve out of >400 global system proposals selected for building onsite at Las Vegas

### • Robotic Satellite Servicing

University of Maryland

Sep 2018 - May 2020

Advisor: [Dave Akin](#) 

- 6 + 8 DoF submersible, pressurized, hydraulic robotic arm; diving tests and software for Ranger and other robots

## HONORS AND AWARDS

### • Best Paper Finalist

Resource-Rational Robot Learning, CoRL 2025

September 2025

### • Graduate Research Fellowship Program (GRFP)

National Science Foundation

March 2023

## SERVICE

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- Guest Speaker at Seattle Robotics Society
- Guest Speaker at Global Innovation Exchange, University of Washington
- Organizer and Award Committee Member: RSS 2025 Off-Road Autonomy Workshop
- Invited to Review: RA-L, T-RO, ICRA, RSS Off-Road Workshop, CoRL, NeurIPS

## MEDIA

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- “National Robotics Week – Latest Physical AI Research, Breakthroughs and Resources”, NVIDIA, 2025 [\[link\]](#)
- “From Simulation to Reality: Building Wheeled Robots with Isaac Lab”, Q&A Talk, 2025 [\[link\]](#)

## OUTREACH & MENTORING

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### • Robotics Research Mentoring

*June 2023 - Present*

*Robot Learning Lab*

- Master’s Students: Siyang Shen → Paxini, Anubhav Vishwakarma → FieldAI, Preet Shah → Research Engineer at General Robotics, Alex Liu → Software Engineer at Amazon
- Undergraduate Students: Laura Wang, Urvi Rutia, Bhaumik Mehta, Bryan Xu, Yanda Bao, Sidharth Rajagopal, Gabe Guo, Alyssa Giedd → Ph.D. at University of Washington
- High School Students: Vansh Chhabra

### • Pre-Application Mentorship Program

*September 2022 - Present*

*University of Washington, Department of Computer Science & Engineering*



- Mentor to students in under-represented or underserved communities considering graduate school